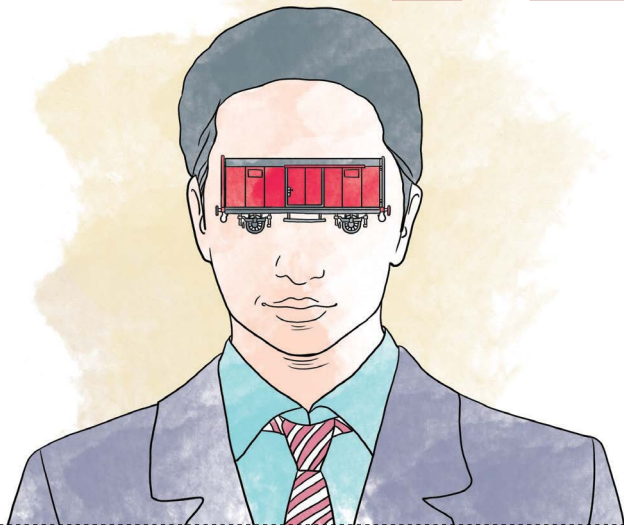


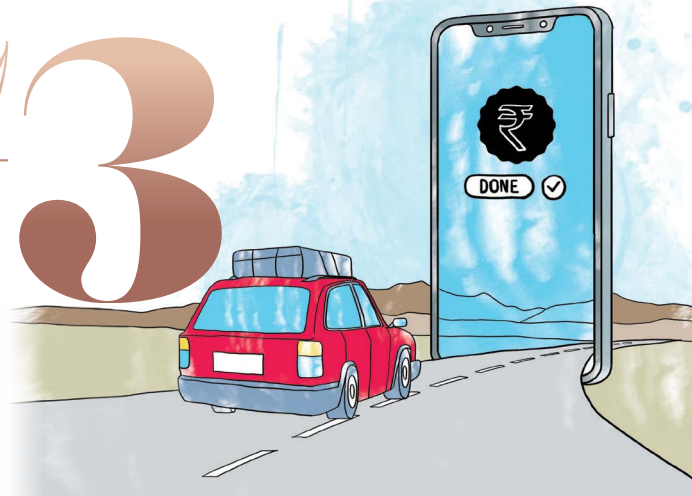
BUILD A RAILWAY OF THE FUTURE

► Hyperloop, bullet and driverless trains—that is where the future of rail mobility is headed. However, these technologies require huge investments and so entities running them should be able to earn a profit. That means policy reforms for rationalising fares and getting private players to invest in Indian Railways while ensuring it remains the cheapest mode of travel. There is also demand for freight rationalisation and flexibility in terms of goods carried.



TOLL AT EASE

► Tolls on national highways have always been a sore point with allegations that while toll agencies mint money for years, consumers pay for badly maintained infrastructure. The government has now been auctioning some high-density highways to private players as part of its monetisation plan but should also regulate the toll charges paid by commuters. An efficient technology-driven automatic toll collection system is needed to ensure there are no long queues at toll plazas.



IMPROVE PUBLIC TRANSPORT

► Metro connectivity has brought convenience like never with time-tabled trains, clean and safe surroundings and reduction in commute time, but at a higher cost. India needs to build efficient bus, rapid rail and monorail systems like those in the West. It must also ensure last-mile connectivity. Incentives to use public transport with dedicated lanes could be a game changer. The governments must also work on innovative financing mechanisms to bail out the ailing state transport services.

